Ideology, Legitimation and Collective Action: Evidence from Chile on the Mechanism of Ideological Inversion

Ismael Puga, *School of Government and Communications, Universidad Central de Chile, Santiago, Chile*
Cristóbal Moya, *Faculty of Sociology, Bielefeld University, Bielefeld, Germany*

We present evidence on a social mechanism of legitimation—ideological inversion—proposing that a fantasy consensus deters collective actions oriented toward social change, even in contexts were individuals support transformations. This fantasy consensus emerges as individuals infer the order's validity mainly from the practices of others, which are largely constrained by social structures. Relying on a factorial survey experiment conducted in Chile, our results support the two main hypotheses from ideological inversion: people systematically overestimate the support for the status quo, and this overestimation has a deterrent effect on collective actions oriented toward social change. We argue that ideological inversion helps explain how legitimation crises often remain hidden, and therefore how political crisis often emerge abruptly. For instance, before the revolt of 2019 Chile was perceived as an example of social stability within Latin America, yet after an ordinary subway fare hike the country erupted in an unrelenting and massive wave of protests. Our findings suggest that the social support for the status quo previously perceived in Chile was a fantasy consensus enforced by constrained practices, and that this fantasy was very effective until recently in deterring social change. Ideological inversion thus provides a mechanism that contributes to explain the stability of social structures and inequalities regardless of individual dispositions or shared norms.

Introduction

What deters people from acting against social structures that disadvantage them? What makes social change so unlikely? The puzzling stability of social orders was a central question for classical sociologists. We present here the Theory of

We are grateful to the Editor and anonymous reviewers of Social Forces, and to Juan Carlos Castillo, Carolina Casas-Cordero, Ana Figueiredo, Raimundo Frei, Monica Gerber, Macarena Orchard, and Carsten Sauer, each of whom provided very constructive feedback on this project. *Please address all correspondence to: Ismael Puga, Universidad Central de Chile, Av. Santa Isabel 1278, Santiago 8330601, Chile. ORCID: 0000-0002-6385-9678; Email: ismael.puga@ucentral.cl*

© The Author(s) 2022. Published by Oxford University Press on behalf of the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill. All rights reserved. For permissions, please e-mail: journals.permissions@oup.com.

Social Forces 101(3) 1519–1551, March 2022
https://doi.org/10.1093/sf/soac032
Advance Access Publication

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

the Ideological Inversion Mechanism (TIIM) as a contribution to these debates, explaining how a conflictive order can be stabilized by a legitimation process requiring neither individual legitimating dispositions nor shared norms. We argue that social crises often hide in plain sight for the same reasons that make them unlikely: because people interpret each other's practices, which are largely constrained by social structures and institutions, as expressive of preferences. Individuals thus overestimate the support for the status quo, and therefore, *they act as if* such support existed. Nonetheless, exceptional events such as massive protests can suddenly give voice to previously silent conflicts, as we illustrate with our study in Chile, months before the country's largest revolt in decades.

Chile had been for decades the Latin American model country for economic and political stability, but in October 2019, it suddenly burst into flame after a hundred high school students decided to protest a subway fare hike. Protests rapidly escalated as indignation and unrest spread. Despite increasingly repressive measures, an unrelenting and massive wave of protests evidenced that the political and economic policies and institutions shaping the Chilean ultraliberal model faced a deep legitimacy crisis. Although researchers had long described a climate of unrest across Chilean society (cfr. Araujo and Martuccelli 2011; Bengoa et al. 1999; Puga 2011), no analysis had foreseen an outbreak like this: the main debate had been *how* individuals justified the status quo, rather than *whether* they actually did so. The protesters themselves, we argue, had not foreseen this outcome. But it happened, and it triggered an unprecedented process of constitutional change with a democratically elected constitutional convention where the sum of the main political actors from the preceding decades barely retained 40% of the seats.

Contemporary sociology can often overlook simmering legitimation crises, such as the one expressed in the Chilean revolt, by focusing excessively on subjective processes of justification. Contrastingly, classical sociology explained the stabilization of social orders through structural and collective mechanisms rather than additions of individual dispositions. Even Weber (1920, 31; 1922, 213), whose sociological methodology emphasized individual action, was emphatic on this: while oftentimes the constellations of individual interests and dispositions suffice to maintain the status quo, the stability question appears every time the contingencies of social life stir these constellations. Hence, Weber proposed that stability depends on *social* legitimation: regardless of their particular inclinations, individuals tend to accept existing hierarchies and structures as long as these display *social validity*. This acceptance occurs because the order is "held by at least part of the actors to define a model or to be binding," and thus, it is "recognized as valid in his society" (Weber 1920, 31–32). Similarly, Durkheim (1893, 63–64) proposed a "collective consciousness", which is external to individuals and defines social categories, institutions and acceptable behaviors. Transgressions against this collective consciousness would be responded to with social reactions of varying severity, which both deterred further transgressions and reinforced the norms' validity. For Marx (1867, 87), capitalist relations of production appear to the producers as the spontaneous result of individual

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

preferences during exchange: as the material realization of a previous ideal reality, and thus as inherently legitimate.

Regardless of how social structures might shape individual inclinations, then, classical sociology explained individuals' stable consent through specific *social relations*: through external, collective processes sustaining the order, which can be generally conceptualized as legitimation. In contrast, when dealing with the problem of compliance, subsequent theories often emphasize structural or collective explanations of *individually* internalized dispositions which only *then*, in turn, explain individuals' acquiescence. While dispositions are socially explained, obedience itself results from individual dispositions. This is the case of Bourdieu's (2000) theory of habitus (cfr. Burawoy 2012), or Lukes' (2005) third dimension of power.[1] This shift in sociological theory can be traced as far back as to Parsons's influence on the reception of sociological classics: Parsons (1951) gave legitimation a large role in his theory yet disregarded the *social* aspect of validity and instead insisted on the centrality of the norms' internalization by *individuals*.

Internalized dispositions are undoubtedly relevant for the stability of social orders: analyses such as Bourdieu's or Parsons's surely expanded the sociological understanding of compliance. However, there remains a core aspect of legitimation that is eminently societal and interactional and thus cannot be captured by addressing how individuals incorporate norms and hierarchies.

If later theories often displaced the social character of legitimation from the explanation of concrete consent to the production of individual dispositions, we observe an even wider gap when comparing classical sociology with current empirical research (see Schoon 2022). Empirically, legitimation is usually addressed as an aggregation of individual mechanisms.[2] Most contemporary research on legitimation stems from two strands: psychologies of legitimacy and empirical social justice studies. The former delves into individuals' motivations to justify the status quo (e.g. Jost et al. 2019; Lerner 1980), while the latter focuses on whether individuals evaluate situations as unfair (e.g. van den Bos et al. 2015).[3] Both perspectives showcase the disjuncture from the collective basis of legitimation processes, focusing instead on the development of dispositions (cfr. Hegtvedt and Johnson 2000). Furthermore, both strands seldom engage in how these dispositions affect concrete, potentially destabilizing actions. Hence, social change often remains beyond their scope, and legitimation research becomes increasingly disentangled from studies on protest or political crises.[4] Even when studies engage with the relation between perceived injustice and collective actions, the latter are often addressed through individual *dispositions toward* collective action (van Zomeren, Postmes and Spears 2008). In our view, whether people *concretely* challenge the status quo or not is the main outcome of any legitimation process.

This gap partly stems from issues of method: both traditional survey studies and qualitative interviews are better suited for studying how individuals' ideas affect their own dispositions and behavior than for assessing the relation between collective phenomena and those individuals. Especially in survey research, the relevance of social validity is difficult to assess. Even when comparing different

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

contexts, measurements of social validity would be typically built as aggregations of individual dispositions, and thus their effects would be hardly distinguishable from the latter.

To bridge the gap between classical theories of *social* legitimation and an empirical focus on *individual* ideas and dispositions, we distinguish individual ideas from their social validity by using a factorial survey (Auspurg and Hinz, 2015). The survey first measures the respondents' ideas and later presents them with a sample of fictional individuals to whom they attribute ideas using equivalent scales. In this way, we differentiate between what individuals report as their own ideas and what they perceive as the common ideas of others. Although the social validity of the status quo is a feature of social orders themselves, and thus we cannot expect it to explain differences across individuals, in this way, we can assess its explanatory power by studying differences in how individuals *perceive* social validity, and thus how their behavior is differently affected by it. Our aim is to address legitimation as a strictly social process while also paying careful attention to how it affects individuals. Taking structural individualism (Hedström and Ylikoski 2010) as a methodological stance, we strive for explanations of social stability explicitly describing how individual consent is produced while highlighting the causal efficacy of irreducible structural and relational phenomena.

Legitimation Mechanisms: Legitimacy, Dissimulation, Inversion

Legitimation is irreducible to individual mechanisms, for it is an intrinsically social process involving social validity. There are two key issues here where TIIM departs from current scholarship on legitimation.

First, we focus on legitimation as an explanatory mechanism for stable compliance, rather than on legitimacy as a feature to be explained. At the core of legitimation is the problem of validity: actors comply with social orders because they recognize this order as collectively validated. The *individual* actor that complies is different from the collective granting validity (cfr. Schoon 2022).

Secondly, validity (and thus legitimation) *might* stem from the fit between the social order and shared beliefs, but it is ultimately communicated through a general alignment of practices across society: a "praxis consensus" (Puga and Moya 2020). This praxis consensus might itself suffice to secure the actors' compliance *regardless* of shared beliefs (cfr. Beetham 2013). Take, for instance, the unequal distribution of "reproductive labor" (Duffy 2007): domestic housework and care-giving tasks. The fact that women do most reproductive labor without being paid communicates itself the social validity of the gender division of labor, *regardless* of whether women and their relatives share beliefs justifying it. The actual existence of shared beliefs justifying the social order is not the only possible mechanism behind the praxis consensus. Indeed, Puga and Moya (2020) distinguish three different *legitimation mechanisms* in sociological theory. Each of these mechanisms provides a different explanation of how *social*

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

legitimation leads individuals to consent to the status quo, disregarding whether they *individually* justify it.

The most classical perspective regarding legitimation corresponds to the mechanism of *social legitimacy*. In this mechanism, there is a *normative* consensus that justifies existing social structures. There are different explanations for this initial match between shared norms and the objective structures: actors in power actively seek to impose justifying norms (Weber 1922, 213); there are relatively institutionalized systems dedicated to reinforcing these norms (Parsons 1951, 94); norms spontaneously adjust to structural transformations (Durkheim 1893, 51–56); etc. Regardless of this first explanatory moment, the gist of social legitimacy is that the status quo generates a sufficient degree of normative consensus to justify itself, thus securing a praxis consensus. Because individuals recognize that most *others* legitimate the status quo, they are compelled to act in legitimating ways regardless of their individual preferences. Once the praxis consensus is enacted, it constantly reinforces the order's social validity, and thus social structures are continually actualized and shielded from critique.

The previous mechanism assumes that the individuals know the real content of the social structures *and* of the normative consensus and can therefore evaluate their reciprocal consistency. Each of the two other mechanisms, *dissimulation* and *ideological inversion*, calls one of these presumptions into question.

The mechanism of *dissimulation* describes a case where the social order cannot generate a normative consensus capable of fully justifying itself, for instance, a capitalistic society successfully fostering shared norms of meritocracy and efficiency but failing to provide moral justifications for inheritance and class stratification. The dissimulation mechanism proposes that generally, actors do not perceive the real workings of social structures and hierarchies; they instead misperceive them as matching with the existing normative consensus. Following the last example, actors might be relatively unaware of the role of stratification and wealth inheritance in the determination of each individual's opportunities, thus enabling legitimation despite the conflict between shared norms and objective structures. Note that dissimulation, as social legitimacy, is not an individual mechanism; it hardly matters if a given individual correctly perceives social structures as conflicting with social norms. Insofar as a widespread misrecognition of social structures secures a certain degree of compliant practice across society, the resulting praxis consensus will deter challengers through the causal efficacy of social validity.

Several theories provide explanations aligned with this mechanism. Notably, for Bourdieu (2000, 142–146), the inherent opacity of social structures hides their arbitrariness and leads the dominated to misrecognize social structures. While more nuanced, the perspective of Chiapello (2003) is still that structural opacity generates an *excess* of legitimation. Some psychosocial theories can be thought of as individual mechanisms leading to the dissimulation mechanism: for Lerner (1980), actors have an innate disposition to believe in a just world, which leads them to distort their perception of society; for Jost et al. (2019), the justification of oppression largely results from palliative cognitive mechanisms enabling the disadvantaged to avoid cognitive dissonance.

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

The mechanism of *ideological inversion*, as well, presumes a conflict between the normative consensus and social structures. However, unlike with dissimulation, individuals are able to realize that the social order is in conflict *with their own* ideas. The problem is rather the perception of shared beliefs: given that shared practices communicate shared preferences, and practices are largely determined by structural constraints, it is unlikely that actors can accurately assess shared beliefs. The opacity lies in *the ideas of others*.

This mechanism is based on an analytical reinterpretation of Marx's concept of ideology as inversion (Puga 2013, 2021, Puga and Moya 2020), drawing insights from analytical sociology (Schmid 2011), rational choice theory (Kuran 1987, 1997; Olson 1965), and game theory (Aumann 1976; Lewis 1969). Marx's social analysis explains socially prevalent ideas by the force of material relations. Ideologists, he claimed, attempt to explain material life as resulting from ideas, and thus, "in all ideology men and their circumstances appear upside-down as in a *camera obscura*" (Marx and Engels 1846, 42). An ideological inversion occurs when the praxis consensus appears to result from a consensus of ideas, while in fact, these ideas become *apparently* shared because of *materially* constrained practices.

In any specific society, individuals enter into social relations independent of their will (Marx 1859, 4). Therefore, *to some extent*, the praxis consensus can be produced in the absence of a normative consensus supporting it. Driven by "the dull compulsion of economic relations" (Marx 1867, 809), workers accept salary relations, women do most reproductive labor without pay, or voters choose candidates who might not "scare" the markets. All this is possible even if most workers are socialists, most women are feminists, or most voters are anarchists in their own individual minds.

Nevertheless, social contingencies often stir these constellations of interests, and thus Marx's "dull compulsion" alone cannot explain long-term stability. In those moments of fragility, ideological inversion enters to scene: we cannot easily distinguish the constrained everyday practices from practices expressing an actual preference. In terms of game theory, structural constraints make it almost impossible to create a *common knowledge* (Aumann 1976) about shared beliefs. Constrained practices entail the *fantasy* of a normative consensus that confers social validity to the social order. When social contingencies somehow interrupt the dull compulsion of economic relations, this apparent social validity deters concrete disruptive actions.

In our account, ideology is not a set of ideas or beliefs defined by their function, dominance, or legitimating orientation (cfr. Althusser 1970, Postone 1993), nor is it a "reified" or "false consciousness" opposed to any "true" knowledge of social structures (cfr. Adorno 1969, 157; Lukács 1923, 54, 93). To begin with, ideology is a feature of exploitative social structures (not of actors' consciousness): capitalist relations create "an *inverted world consciousness*, because *they are an inverted world*" (Marx 1844, 53). More specifically, ideology is an inversion mechanism brought up by material forces pushing actors in contradictory directions: structural constraints propel them to adopt legitimating practices, while exploitation pushes them to adopt ideas opposed to these structures and

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

their own practice. Ideology is a social process of legitimation triggered when social structures make it impossible for social actors to act as they think. Therefore, TIIM enables a *critique of ideology* as something radically different from legitimacy, while avoiding the problematic "intellectualist" implications of false consciousness theories (cfr. Bourdieu 2000, 177). The "falseness" of ideology does not emanate from actors' consciousness but "from the social structure itself" (Burawoy 2012, 203) and its internal contradictions. Within the Marxist tradition, this conception stands closer to Gramsci's (1932, 157) insistence on ideology as real, as a material and contradictory "terrain" where actors are inserted, and especially closer to Burawoy's (2012) theory of mystification.

Ideological inversion is also different from "preference falsification" (Kuran 1987) or "pluralistic ignorance" (Prentice and Miller 1996): TIIM does not require actors to silence their opinions. Individuals might well be very vocal about their preferences within the scope of their milieu, but this will not change the contribution that their everyday constrained practice makes to an apparent consensus beyond this milieu. The problem is instead structural; the contradiction between material relations and ideas cannot be avoided insofar as these material relations place actors' ideas and their practices in contradiction. On the one hand, actors are driven in their everyday practices by the need to adapt to social structures. On the other hand, actors can only rely on the practices of others to infer the content of shared ideas. Collective actions provide a way of communicating the real content of collective preferences (Puga 2021), yet it is precisely collective actions that are made unlikely by this ideological effect.

Actors infer the existence of a justifying normative consensus from the praxis consensus, but the praxis consensus largely results from material constraints. There emerges then a "fantasy consensus" (Puga and Moya 2020). With regards to the example of reproductive labor: practices aligned with the gender division of labor might result in part from households maximizing economic outputs within a capitalistic labor market with a marked gender pay gap. As reproductive labor is both necessary and time-consuming, in most households with men and women, it will be more efficient if the former engages in paid work and the latter in unpaid work. Structural constraints (the labor market, the pay gap, and the lack of socialized care) produce a praxis consensus, one where most households assign most reproductive labor to women, regardless of individual preferences. As a result, however, this gender division of labor presents itself as validated by most people, as if resulting from actors' ideas about gender and domestic labor. This will happen even if, for instance, most women and many men consider this situation unjust. When opportunities for challenging this status quo arise, individuals will react *as if* this fantasy consensus were real.

Note that ideological inversion and the fantasy consensus only come into play, in the previous example, once the gender division of labor has already been crystallized into the social structure. Indeed, none of the three legitimation mechanisms explain how structures and hierarchies come to be. Political opportunities, internal and external conflicts, and technological changes, among many other factors, intertwine to generate macrosocial changes. The scope of legitimation mechanisms, within this complex history, is to help explain why

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

social structures often resist these contingencies, why profound social changes are relatively rare.

Drawing from analytical sociology, we consider these three explanations to represent not laws but mechanisms (Hedström and Ylikoski, 2010). Different mechanisms might better explain different concrete contexts. Further, in a given historical social order, social legitimacy might explain the stability of political institutions, while inversion better explains compliance with structural racism, and both mechanisms might intertwine in legitimating different elements of salary relations.

At least in capitalist regimes such as contemporary Chile, however, TIIM predicts ideological inversion as the *primary* legitimating mechanism. This expectation ultimately rests on presumptions about the critical capabilities of actors. We doubt capitalism can foster a sufficient normative consensus while disadvantaging large social groups, as we doubt people can be systematically tricked into misperceiving social structures.

The Inversion Hypotheses

We establish two hypotheses based on the TIIM. In each, we distinguish an Ego—a given individual—and an Alter—other people whom the Ego perceives.

The first hypothesis (H1) is that people systematically overestimate the support for the status quo among others. Thus, when comparing an Ego and an Alter with similar characteristics and behavior, the Ego's ideas will be systematically and significantly more oriented toward the rejection of the status quo, while ideas she attributes to the Alter will be more oriented toward the legitimation of the status quo. This occurs because the Ego infers the ideas of the Alter from their practices, which are adapted to material structures and institutions rather than to preferences.

The second hypothesis (H2) posits that the systematic overestimation of social support for the status quo deters collective action oriented toward social change. Therefore, we expect that stronger overestimations of the Alter's support for the status quo will lead the Ego to lower participation in collective actions aimed toward social change. This relationship should hold even once the Ego's *own ideas* and other factors are controlled for. This occurs because the fantasy consensus emulates the social validity of the social order, thus deterring social actors from challenging it.[5]

Data and Analytical Strategy

Our case of study is Chile, a country now engaged in constitutional change after a massive civil revolt seriously threatened the government and demanded profound changes to political and economic institutions. The revolt of October 2019 presents Chile as a crucial case for the proposed hypotheses. The sheer size and the persistence of the demonstrations, as well as the results from the 2020 constitutional referendum (78% rejected the current constitution), made

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

manifest that Chileans did not share a normative consensus on their political and economic systems. However, Chilean institutions seemed stable and barely contested for at least 30 years prior to the revolt. This makes the case both adequate for TIIM assumptions and stringent for its hypotheses. On the one hand, TIIM claims to explain precisely situations as this: social orders can be stable without fostering actual popular support. On the other hand, the case allows us to test whether even on the brink of societal change, the mechanism of ideological inversion can explain the quiescence of individuals and thus the stabilization of social orders.

This study is based on a probabilistic survey ($N = 1{,}290$), the Survey of Social Practices and Legitimation Mechanisms (EPSOC), conducted between October 2018 and March 2019, and covering the population between 18 and 59 years in three major Chilean cities: Antofagasta, Temuco, and Santiago (the capital).[6]

EPSOC features a specific experiment to evaluate our hypotheses: a factorial survey design (Auspurg and Hinz 2015) aimed at surveying what ideas interviewees attribute to *others*. First, the survey asks respondents about their individual views on different social debates, two of which we analyze here.[7] These items are not intended as measurements of general dispositions but as relative preferences regarding historically concrete debates in contemporary Chile. Both items use 11-point scales with poles representing opposed political and economic views: one pole represents support for the status quo in the Chilean context, and the other represents a preference for social and political transformation.

The first item measures individual ideas regarding politics and social change, with the left pole indicating support for the status quo ("Chile needs stability, order, and stronger authorities") and the right pole indicating a preference for change ("Chile needs social changes, more participation and public debate"). Attempts at reform in Chile have often crashed against the very restrictive Constitution established in 1980, and thus, social movements have long denounced the current political institutions as authoritarian and demanded a participative process to replace them (Siavelis 2016), a process finally started after the revolt of 2019. For ease of exposition, we will refer to this scale as ideas on the *political dimension*.

The second item aims at measuring individual ideas regarding economic policy, specifically, on the state control and taxing of large corporations. Since the dictatorship's reforms in 1975, and with limited changes until now, Chile became a radical ultraliberal "experiment" where large corporations enjoy minimal regulation and taxation, and private companies control most basic services (Rodríguez 2020). The left pole signals rejection of this ultraliberal status quo in Chile ("Heavier controls and higher taxes for large corporations"), and the right pole signals support for the status quo ("More freedom and less taxes for large corporations"). We refer to this scale as ideas on the *economics dimension*.

Then, each respondent was acquainted with eight vignettes (one of 32 different decks following a D-efficient design, randomly assigned), each of which described a fictional person. The vignettes feature people of different demographics, social positions and backgrounds and with differences in key practices that could be used as clues about their ideas, namely, the candidates

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

for whom they voted in the last presidential elections (including people who did not vote) and the type of school they enrolled their children in (including people without children in school age).[8]

A translated vignette example:

> *Andrea is 27 years old; she works as a teacher. Financially, she is doing well. Her father has a university degree. She lives with her family in an impoverished neighborhood of Santiago.*
>
> *In the last presidential elections, she voted for Beatriz Sánchez, the candidate of the Frente Amplio. Andrea enrolled her children at a public school.*

For each vignette, interviewees were asked to attribute ideas to the person described. In this way, we measure how different characteristics affect what respondents think that *others* think. The scales used for these ideas of others are equivalent to those used to express the ideas of respondents themselves and thus can be easily compared.

In our analysis, we call the survey respondents "Ego", while each fictional person from the vignettes is referred to as "Alter". Both Ego's and Alter's ideas were arrayed from 1, "strongest support for the status quo", to 11, "strongest rejection of the status quo".

Key Variables

In addition to the sociodemographics for Ego and Alter, the key variables for our analysis include Ego and Alter's ideas on the economic and political dimension, Ego's participation in collective actions oriented toward social change, and Ego and Alter's behavior regarding both school choice and their vote in the 2017 presidential elections. Descriptive statistics are provided in Appendix A (Tables A1 and A2).

We have already introduced the measurements of Ego and Alter's ideas on politics and economics. Sociodemographics include sex, age, city, monthly wages, class and occupational status, and the educational status of the father of Ego and Alter. Wages are expressed in thousands of Chilean Pesos, roughly 1.30 USD. Class and occupational status were operationalized in three different indicators: first, a binary indicator "Firm Owner", which takes a positive value when Ego (or Alter) is the owner of a midsize or larger firm; second, a binary indicator of "reproductive labor" taking a positive value when Ego (or Alter) works exclusively on caregiving and housework tasks at their household; and finally, an ISEI score measuring the relative status of occupations (Ganzeboom, Graaf, and Treiman 1992). Owners are coded with varying ISEI scores according to the specifics of their reported business and work. In models, people engaged in full-time reproductive labor are assigned with an ISEI of 1. Father's educational status is a binary indicator, identifying fathers with or without a university degree.

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

School choice distinguishes among the three types of school in Chile.[9] Regarding voting behavior, we distinguish five categories regarding the first round of the last presidential elections in Chile: voters of the rightwing candidate (from the "Chile Vamos" coalition), who was elected; voters of the center-left candidate (from the "Nueva Mayoría" coalition); voters of the leftwing candidate (from the "Frente Amplio" coalition); voters of other candidates; and finally, persons who did not vote. There are no voters for the minor candidates among the fictional Alter.

Finally, the indicator of participation in collective actions exists only for Ego. This indicator is a binary taking a positive value when the respondent had *actively participated*, during the year before the interview, in at least one collective action (public demonstration, strike, occupation, or organization meeting) for the sake of a social movement oriented toward social change. Explicitly surveyed movements included the labor movement, indigenous people movement, feminist movement, environmentalist movement, the movement against the Chilean pension system, and the movement for public education. Participation in other, self-reported movements was considered, unless they were coded as not oriented toward social change. This coding is context-sensitive: for instance, given that abortion laws in Chile have long been extremely restrictive, "pro-life" movements were excluded as a "defensive" movement. The distinction is relevant: if ideological inversion deters collective action by magnifying the social validity of the status quo, this applies only for actions challenging this status quo.

Measuring Ideological Bias

To assess our hypotheses, we need first to measure how much people overestimate or underestimate the social support for the status quo. We did this by comparing Ego's and Alter's ideas.

A first step toward a meaningful comparison was modeling both variables, Ego and Alter's ideas, through equivalent predictors (see Table A3 in the appendix). We used linear regressions with robust estimators of variance to predict Ego's ideas and maximum likelihood estimation (MLE) fixed effect models with observed information matrix estimations (nested at the level of respondents) to predict Alter's ideas.[10] The predicted values from these models provide an estimation of the *average* ideas of people with different positions and practices (the models predicting Ego's ideas for both dimensions) and the ideas attributed to people of different positions and practices, *on average*, by the respondents (the models predicting Alter's ideas for both dimensions). Observed ideas and attributions might vary a great deal around the predicted values, but these values are still an unbiased estimation of profile averages for both Ego and Alter.

Subsequently, we calculated four different values for each respondent in our sample. Solving the models on Ego's ideas on both dimensions, we calculated the average ideas on economics and politics for the *profile* of each person in our

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

sample; we call these values *Ego's Expected Ideas* on economics and politics, respectively.

We then took the equation from the model on Alter's ideas on economics, and we solved it *for the characteristics of each respondent* (not of the vignettes, from which the model was calculated). In this way, we obtained the ideas on economics that the people in our sample *would attribute on average* to each person in the same sample. We call this value the *Socially Attributed Ideas* on economics (socially attributed to Ego). By using the model on Alter's ideas on politics in the same way, we calculated the *Socially Attributed Ideas* on politics.

Unlike the ideas attributed to the vignettes, the *Socially Attributed Ideas* match exactly the characteristics of our respondents. To assess H1, we can measure how much each respondent's support for the status quo is overestimated or underestimated by their peers by comparing Socially Attributed Ideas with *Ego's Expected Ideas*.

To assess H2, we needed an indicator of the individual degree to which each respondent tends to under- or overestimate the support for the status quo among others. We obtained this indicator first by inverting the previous process: we took the equations from the models on Ego's ideas (1 and 3), and we solved them for the characteristics of each *vignette*, thus obtaining a score with the average ideas *observed* among people like those represented in each vignette. These are the *Ideas Expected of Alter* on politics and economics (IEA): the ideas a respondent should attribute to each vignette if she neither underestimated nor overestimated Alter's support for the status quo. By comparing these values with Alter's Ideas (AI)—the scores actually attributed by each respondent to each vignette—we obtained a measure of the bias implied in each particular attribution. These values, which we call *Ideological Bias on Alter* (IBA), were obtained through the following formula:

$$IBA = \ln\left(\frac{AI}{IEA}\right) \tag{1}$$

This is the natural logarithm[11] of the ratio between Alter's Ideas as attributed by Ego and Alter's Expected Ideas. As a result, IBA has a value of zero when the respondent attributes to the vignette exactly the average ideas of similar people in our sample. Positive values of IBA represent a respondent overrating the *rejection* of the status quo by the person in the vignette, while negative values represent a respondent overrating the *support* for the status quo by the person in the vignette.[12] For each dimension, each respondent has one value of IBA for all eight vignettes evaluated. We finally obtained *Ego's Ideological Bias* (EIB), a measure of the respondents' individual bias when attributing ideas to others, either toward or against the status quo in each dimension, by averaging their IBA values in each dimension:

$$EIB_i = \sum \frac{IBA_{ji}}{m_i} \tag{2}$$

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Thus, for each *i* Ego, we calculated the average IBA value across the *j* Alter that she rated, where *m* is the total number of vignettes rated by *i* (in this study, eight). As the vignettes presented to each respondent were balanced in their attributes, all respondents were evaluated against a similar standard.[13] Positive values of EIB describe respondents overrating the *rejection* of the status quo, while negative values describe respondents overrating the *support* for the status quo. These are our explanatory factors for assessing the effects of the inversion mechanism on collective action participation.

Results

As shown in Figure 1, in general, the respondents hold ideas markedly critical of the status quo. Especially regarding the economics dimension, most people locate themselves near the critical pole of the scale. Despite the design of this study focusing on hypotheses related to the mechanism of ideological inversion, these initial results also speak against both the mechanisms of social legitimacy and of dissimulation. If either of these mechanisms were the main explanation for the stability of the status quo in Chile, we should observe a distribution of Ego's ideas favorable toward the defense of the status quo—either because people have incorporated beliefs that justify political institutions and economic policy (social legitimacy) or because people generally misperceive them as justified by their beliefs (dissimulation).[14] Instead, the results describe a suitable case for the study of the ideological inversion mechanism, as individuals in general describe their own ideas as in conflict with the status quo.

Assessing the fantasy consensus

People do not favor the social and economic order. Having established this context, we can assess H1 by comparing *Ego's Expected Ideas* with *Socially Attributed Ideas*. If the respondents indeed systematically overrate the others' support for the status quo, *Socially Attributed Ideas* will be significantly more pro-status quo than *Ego's Expected Ideas*. Figure 2 maps the values of *Socially Attributed Ideas* and *Ego's Expected Ideas* on both dimensions for each respondent. The solid line represents the null hypothesis, in which the ideas people attribute to others are neither overly favorable nor overly unfavorable towards the status quo. The dashed line represents the actual linear fit between the two variables.

Both graphs in the figure show a clear pattern. *Socially Attributed Ideas* for each respondent are systematically biased toward the support for the status quo when compared with the *Expected Ideas* for that respondent. Only in a few cases are the expected ideas more oriented to the status quo than the socially attributed ideas. In other words, almost every person in this survey is believed by the others to be much less critical of the status quo than they actually are.

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Figure 1. Distribution of Ego's ideas on economics and politics

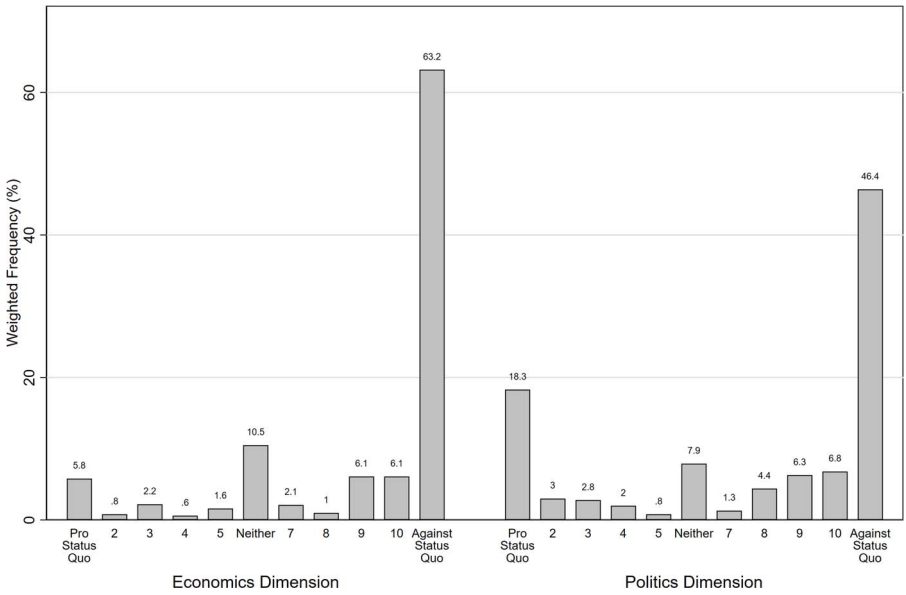
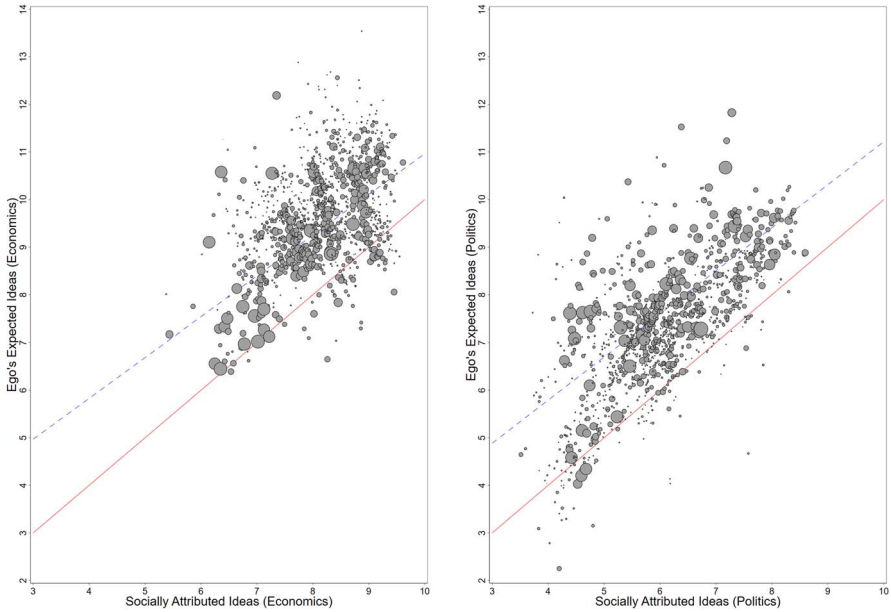


Figure 2. Scatterplot of Ego's Expected Ideas and Socially Attributed Ideas



Dashed line: observed linear fit. Solid line: reference for EEI = SAI.

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Furthermore, if we regress Ego's Expected Ideas using Socially Attributed Ideas as a unique factor, we obtain regression coefficients that are rather close to 1: 0.86 in the economic dimension and 0.90 in the politics dimension (see appendix, Table A4). This finding suggests that usually, respondents interpret rather correctly the differences in the ideas of others, cued by these others' different positions and practices. However, they add to these interpretations a stable bias toward support for the status quo. People are able to successfully pinpoint the *relative* position of each other's preferences, but they still presume the status quo to be more legitimate than it is. This constant bias neatly reflects the expected effects of the ideological inversion mechanism, thus supporting H1.

Another way of addressing the stability of this bias across social categories is using paired t tests to compare both variables in different subsamples. We conducted such tests for each category in our analysis variables (see appendix, Table A5). The difference, with *Socially Attributed Ideas* being always more oriented toward the legitimation of the status quo than *Ego's Expected Ideas*, remains statistically significant in both dimensions across all 21 subsamples.[15] Thus, we conclude there is strong evidence supporting H1: the respondents overrate the support of the status quo among others, and they do so in a systematic and stable way across every category we analyzed. There is a systematic and relevant gap between the consensus actually existing among the surveyed population, which is critical of the status quo, and the consensus perceived by that same population, which legitimates the status quo. There is a fantasy consensus among Chileans. At least, there was a fantasy consensus before October 2019.

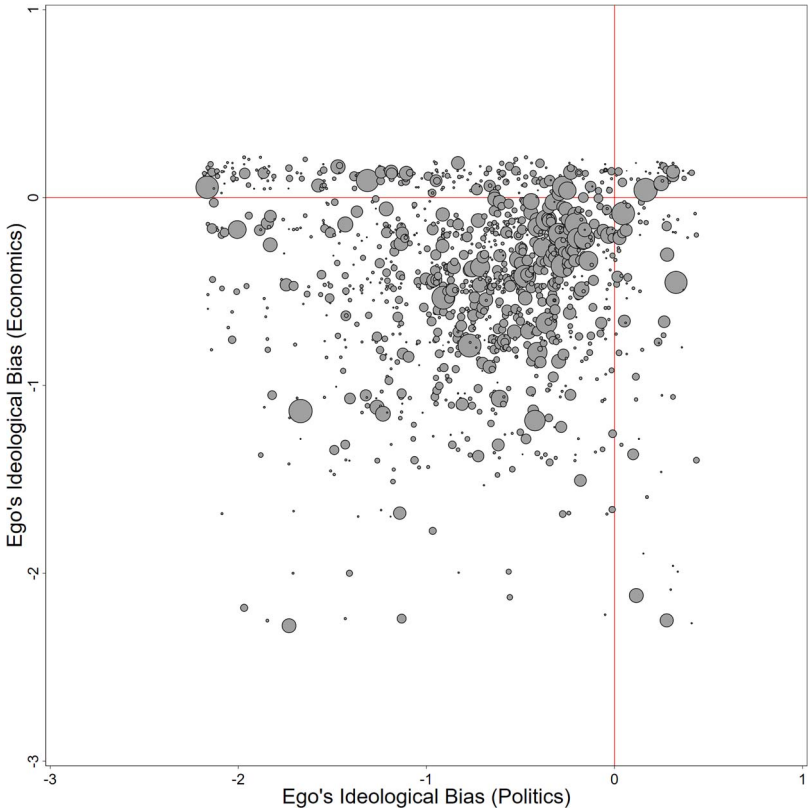
Ideology and Action Toward Change

There remains the question regarding the effect of this fantasy consensus on the participation in collective actions (H2). We start by describing Ego's overrating of others' support for or rejection of the status quo, relying on Ego's Ideological Bias (EIB). As we could expect from the previous results, Figure 3 shows that the participants' average EIB is markedly negative: people tend to overrate the social support for the status quo. There is variance, however, and some individuals slightly overrate the rejection of the status quo. The figure shows as well that EIB scores from both dimensions are not correlated ($r = .036$, $P = .195$). This lack of correlation describes ideological bias not as a persistent individual trait. The fantasy consensus might be more evident for some groups in one dimension and for other groups in a different dimension. For example, older respondents have a stronger (negative) bias on the political dimension ($r = -.099$, $P = .000$) and a weaker bias on the economic dimension ($r = .088$, $P = .002$); older respondents might be more receptive to practices such as voting and less impressed (in comparison) by the others' economic behavior due to their longer experience as household managers (Tables A6 and A7).

To test H2, we implemented logistic models on the individual participation into collective actions oriented toward social change. As *lower* EIB scores represent a stronger overestimation of the support for the status quo, TIIM

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Figure 3. Scatterplot of Ego's Ideological Bias in Economics and Politics dimensions



expects a *positive* effect of Ego's Ideological Bias on the individual likelihood of participating in such actions. In other words, we expect that the more individuals are biased toward the fantasy consensus (a *lower* value of EIB), the less likely they are to engage in collective actions oriented toward change. Table 1 summarizes the findings of our logistic models.[16]

The first model considers only control variables, which include demographics, school choice and voting behavior. The second model adds our variables of interest: Ego's Ideological Bias on the politics and economics dimensions. As expected by TIIM, the bias on the politics dimension has a positive effect on the probability of participation in collective actions. The bias on the economic dimension, however, yields no significant effect.

The third model evaluates whether the effect of Ego's Ideological Bias holds after controlling for the respondents' individual ideas. Indeed, the positive effect of the bias on the political dimension remains almost equal, suggesting that this is a distinct effect not explained by each individual's ideas. The fantasy consensus deters individuals from collective action, regardless of their own preferences.

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Table 1. Logistic Models Predicting Participation in Collective Actions Oriented Toward Social Change (Summary)

	Model 1	Model 2		Model 3	
Ego's Ideological Bias					
On Economics		0.986		0.830	
		(1.163)		(1.183)	
On Politics		1.702	***	1.582	***
		(1.136)		(1.143)	
Ego's Ideas					
On Economics				1.087	**
				(1.028)	
On Politics				1.068	***
				(1.019)	
Pseudo R2 (McFadden)	0.160	0.170		0.186	
N	1,284	1,281		1,271	
Controls	Yes	Yes		Yes	

Model coefficients expressed as Odd Ratios (exponentiated standard errors in parentheses).
$^{*}P <= 0.05$. $^{**}P <= 0.01$. $^{***}P <= 0.001$.

These results provide important evidence for the role of ideological inversion in the deterrence of collective actions, as the effect of Ego's Ideological Bias on the political dimension remains after all controls and interactions are included. While the bias on the economic dimension does not show a significant effect, it is reasonable that the mechanism's effects on collective action are triggered through the political dimension, as it most directly measures the support for social change.

Discussion and Conclusion

We have proposed that the sociological study of legitimation processes should not be limited to the analysis of individual dispositions for or against the acceptance of the status quo. Classical theory, in general, predicts that the stability of social orders depends ultimately on societal mechanisms that operate with relative autonomy from individual inclinations. Otherwise, social orders would be continually dependent on their ability to foster enough support across social groups, a thesis that would not hold up to historical scrutiny (Beetham, 2013; Burawoy 2012).

We have described how people in Chile shared ideas and preferences rather critical of the status quo: overwhelmingly, they stood for deep political reforms and against core tenets of Chilean economic policy. Neither social legitimacy nor dissimulation seem plausible as legitimation mechanisms in this context, as most individual actors clearly oppose the status quo. At the time of the survey,

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

however, the country boasted an impressive political stability, a center-rightwing millionaire had been recently elected president, and the legitimacy of Chile's neoliberal policies seemed monolithic. Our results exhibit how a mechanism of inversion inspired by Marx's concept of ideology can explain legitimation in this setting.

Our findings provide evidence that people systematically overestimate the support for the status quo among others, about the existence of a fantasy consensus. As TIIM predicts, there is an important surplus of social validity that is neither produced by the social order's ability to articulate a normative consensus justifying itself nor by dissimulation of its content but by generating the *appearance* of a social consensus. TIIM explains this fantasy consensus through the need of individuals to adapt their everyday practices to already given social structures and institutions. These constrained practices add up to a praxis consensus, which is the main source for individuals to infer the contents of shared beliefs in their society. Material constraints disguise themselves as dominant ideas.

Furthermore, we found that the disjuncture between individuals' ideas and the fantasy consensus holds across different social cleavages. This consistency supports the claim that ideological inversion is a mechanism working at a societal level. While different groups might be prone to stronger or weaker biases on different dimensions, none of them operates *outside* of this ideological effect.

We found that respondents predict rather precisely the relative views of different social profiles but systematically overestimate pro-status quo views. This finding implies that social actors are generally able to successfully interpret the differences in interests and norms across social groups, but ideology distorts their general perception of consensus nonetheless. This is fitting, as TIIM does not propose that people have any cognitive disposition to misrepresent the ideas of others; rather, it is the social structure in general that is able to present itself as more legitimate than it actually is. In line with Marx' texts, upon which this theory builds, the ideological problem is not an ideal problem that occurs in the minds of social actors but, rather, a material and structural effect that is relatively independent from actors' internal dispositions.

The fantasy consensus is not innocuous; it effectively deters collective action oriented toward social change. Individuals with a stronger bias toward perceiving others as supporting of the status quo are less likely to participate in concrete contentious actions, *regardless of their own ideas* (and other control variables).

By analyzing the effect of individual differences on ideological biases, we make use of individuals' heterogeneity to assess the causal efficacy of a collective phenomenon. However, the ideological bias is widespread, stable, and works across different social cleavages always in the same direction: legitimating the status quo. Therefore, its relevance goes far beyond explaining differences among individuals: it affects all individuals to varying extents. Given our results, one could extrapolate that if there were no process of ideological inversion—i.e., without the structurally driven tendency to overrate the support for the status quo—*on average, every person* in the sample would have their odds of participating in collective actions increased by nearly 40%.[17]

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Our findings thus provide strong evidence for TIIM as a promising theory explaining how a social order can legitimize itself without marshalling a normative consensus. Because inversion works through the material enforcement of the fantasy of a consensus, it also helps explain how legitimation crises often remain hidden shortly before erupting. Our analysis shows that underneath the stable appearance of Chilean neoliberalism, a radical and somewhat invisible dissent remained dormant, yet inversion was still able to deter contention.

Relying on structural constraints, on the dull production of a praxis consensus as an explanation for the emergence of an intersubjective fantasy with very real effects, TIIM allows a critique of ideology while not imputing flawed consciousness to social actors. This position helps TIIM address both the long stability of Chilean neoliberalism and events such as the revolt of 2019, and to do so without resorting to sudden and puzzling leaps of consciousness. With the revolt, people did not discover any hidden truth about neoliberalism in Chile or any social problem they had failed to recognize before. They had a rare simultaneous glimpse of each other's actual views. It is tempting to frame the students who stormed the subway stations during the Chilean October as the innocent child from *The Emperor's New Clothes*, who momentarily breaks the fantasy by speaking the truth (the emperor is naked!). But truth itself, we argue with these findings, could hardly make a dent in ideology. Ideological inversion is rooted in constrained and socially shared practices, not just in words (and much less in lies). Rather, on that day, thousands took a fleeting chance to directly confront and challenge the (perceived) consensus in Chile: they tried to reach the emperor, to grab his invisible clothes and tear them apart. But as they did, they found there were no clothes, no actual consensus. There was only fantasy. And then there was nothing but a naked emperor, and everyone bore witness.

Limitations

The scope of these results faces two main limitations. The first is related to the problem of generalization beyond the Chilean case. It might be the case, for instance, that in other capitalist countries the support for the status quo is higher, although comparable studies on the legitimation of economic inequalities do not suggest that Chile is a unique case in this regard. Even if Chile were indeed a peculiar case of an illegitimate social order, this does not imply that elsewhere we would not observe the reported gap between the ideas actually shared by the population and the perceived consensus. Recent findings in the U.S., for instance, point to people generally underestimating the extent to which others think economic inequality has negative consequences (Day 2021).

Implications and Further Research

TIIM provides a promising approach to further understanding how contemporary societies manage to remain stable despite the inequalities they entail. Thus, we consider that these results have important implications for social theory as well as for social research on legitimating attitudes, on collective actions, and on social change in general.

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Beyond the specific hypotheses of TIIM, we have proposed a novel methodology for assessing the intersubjective problem of social consensuses by using factorial survey designs. Researchers proposing other legitimating mechanisms might benefit from these techniques to empirically study the perceived social validity of a social order.

As noted above, further research on TIIM mainly requires additional testing of the hypotheses here evaluated. However, there are also further research questions that emerge from these findings. For example, what exactly determines the ideas attributed to others? While we have modeled Alter's ideas, our focus has been on producing models comparable to those of Ego, and thus, we have not analyzed here how the respondents' characteristics affect their attribution of ideas to different types of people. Closely related is the question on what social groups tend to have stronger ideological biases on different dimensions; exploring this would greatly help further specify the processes involved in ideological inversion.

Another important consideration regards another claim of TIIM (Puga 2021): that collective actions, themselves deterred by the fantasy consensus, should be the main mechanism to dismantle the ideological appearance of the status quo's legitimacy. Processes of social mobilization such as the 2019 revolt present opportunities for social actors to question the monolithic appearance of the fantasy consensus. While in everyday life, individuals are mostly driven by social structures in ways that reinforce the fantasy consensus, collective actions enable actors to publicly represent their actual shared preferences. Longitudinal studies could help probe how the semblance of a fantasy consensus and the emergence of collective actions intertwine in time.

Finally, it would be relevant to explore other societal effects of this inversion mechanism. In particular, as the fantasy consensus is distanced from shared beliefs, for most people, ideological inversion implies a belief that others hold ideas significantly opposed to their own. Such a generalized conception may damage actors' ability to depend on shared values and norms in their social relations, hence increasing perceived anomie and hindering social cohesion (Puga and Moya 2020).

Notes

1. Burawoy's (2012) description of consent production is a remarkable exception. Foucault's (1977) analyses of discipline and subjectification are difficult to classify in these terms.
2. There are exceptions to this trend, such as the work of Ridgeway and Correll (2006) on the formation of status beliefs.
3. There is a third strand of ethnographic research that has produced detailed accounts of how different groups develop political orientations that are seemingly against their interests (Cramer 2016, Hochschild 2016). While dealing with collective processes and paying attention to how social contexts constrain individual decisions, often these works focus on how social groups acquire certain mindsets or identities that then lead individuals in their action.

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

4. Contrastingly, scholars studying collective action pay close attention to collective mechanisms directly deterring or fostering social change (e.g., Feldman 2004, François et al. 2021, McAdam, Tarrow and Tilly 2001). Legitimation mechanisms, however, play a limited role in this literature.
5. Note that this hypothesis is different from a collective action dilemma (Olson 1965): H2 implies that a fantasy consensus deters individuals not because of the expected utility of free-riding but because the status quo presents itself as socially legitimated.
6. Together, these cities make up approximately 40% of Chile's population. The questionnaires were applied in person using computer-assisted personal interviews (CAPI). The response rate (RR1) was 59.3%. Detailed procedures, questionnaire, data, and scripts for the full reproduction of our results available at: https://osf.io/dz79r/
7. These two dimensions were selected after a qualitative inquiry consisting of eight discussion groups where participants discussed the general ideas attributable to people described in vignettes as those used here. The position of people regarding large firms and corporations, on one side, and regarding the need to change the political system, on the other, clearly emerged as the main dimensions defining an ideal space where people were located. As general issues, these dimensions allow the study of the effects of ideological inversion on the behavior of the general population, as opposed to specific issues where, for instance, only specific groups would consider directly participating in related collective actions.
8. The fictional persona in the vignettes varied across 9 factors with different categories. Table A1 in Appendix A details the different categories for each factor as well as the procedure for assigning first names to the vignettes. In total, there are 32,768 different possible combinations. From this theoretical population, 256 combinations were selected as a sample and then assigned to 32 decks with 8 vignettes each. Each survey respondent was randomly assigned to one of these decks. The selection of these Alters follows a D-efficient design (Auspurg and Hinz 2015). In a D-efficient design, the many possible samples from the theoretical population are compared by an algorithm to optimize the following criteria: balancing the frequency of all categories within each factor, minimizing the correlation between different factors, and optimizing these criteria within each different deck. Due to their randomization and balance across decks, Alter characteristics are uncorrelated with Ego characteristics. The order in which vignettes were presented to the respondent were also randomized at the interviewee level.
9. Public schools, administered in Chile by local governments; charter schools, privately managed yet financed through public subsidies; and private schools, financed through fees.
10. We use these models because the observed distribution of Alter and (especially) Ego's ideas is rather skewed (see Results). Selected models provide unbiased estimations in this context.
11. The use of the logarithm of a ratio has a long history in social justice research. It is widely used to measure feelings of injustice since Jasso (1978) proposed

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

her model on the justice of earnings. This approach provides us with an elegant solution to linearize the relation between an expected outcome (the average value of Alter's ideas as predicted by the respondents' models) and an actual outcome (the ideas attributed to Alter by the respondent).

12. An inverted formula, with AI as divisor and IEA as dividend, would also be possible. We took this option, first, because it made interpretation easier (with scores having expected effects in the same direction as Ego's ideas), and second, because it provided a slightly stricter setting for testing TIIM hypotheses: using AI as the dividend gives the underestimation of the support for the status quo a greater weight than its overestimation. All the presented results hold using both alternatives.
13. This can be proved by running a null MLE model on Alter's Expected Ideas for each dimension: both output a Rho coefficient of zero, indicating that the variance between respondents is negligible (see Appendix A, Table A6).
14. This evidence does not enable a comparison of the relative relevance of legitimacy versus dissimulation mechanisms. Our aim, instead, is to showcase the primacy of ideological inversion.
15. These results by subsamples hold as well if we use self-reported Ego's Ideas instead of Ego's Expected ideas.
16. Full regression tables in Appendix A, Table A7. The binary identifying firm owners is excluded, as positive values perfectly predicted failure to participate in collective actions.
17. Average Ego's Ideological Bias on the politics dimension is −0.635, and the odds ratio for this factor is 1.582. An average increase of 0.635 in EIB (bringing it to zero) would increase the average odds for participation by 37%.

Funding

This work was supported by the Agencia Nacional de Investigación y Desarrollo (grant numbers CONICYT/FONDECYT/11160413 and CONICYT/FONDECYT/1171072).

About the Authors

Ismael Puga is an assistant professor in the School of Government at Universidad Central de Chile. His current research focuses on legitimation processes and collective actions. He has published in outlets such as Feminist Economics, Social Movement Studies, and Revista Internacional de Sociología.

Cristóbal Moya is a research fellow in the Chair of Social Inequality and Social Structure Analysis at Bielefeld University (Germany). His current research focuses on legitimation processes and empirical justice. He has published in outlets such as CEPAL Review, Psychology of Violence, and Revista Internacional de Sociología.

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

References

Adorno, Theodor. 1969. "Subject and Object". In *Subject and Object*, edited by Groff, R. (2014), pp. 149–64. New York: Bloomsbury.

Althusser, Louis. 1970. "Ideology and Ideological State Apparatuses". In *Lenin and Philosophy and other Essays*, edited by Althusser, L. (1971), pp. 127–88. New York: Monthly Review Press.

Araujo, Kathya, and Danilo Martuccelli. 2011. "La inconsistencia posicional." *Revista Cepal* 2011(103):165–78.

Aumann, Robert. 1976. "Agreeing to Disagree." *Annals of Statistics* 4(6):1236–9.

Auspurg, Katrin, and Thomas Hinz. 2015. *Factorial Survey Experiments*. Thousand Oaks: Sage Publications.

Beetham, David. 2013. *The Legitimation of Power*. London: Macmillan.

Bengoa, José, Francisca Márquez, and Susana Aravena. 1999. *La Desigualdad*. Santiago: SUR.

Bos, Kees van den, Russell Cropanzano, Jessica Kirk, Guillermina Jasso, and Tyler G. Okimoto. 2015. "Expanding the Horizons of Social Justice Research: Three Essays on Justice Theory." *Social Justice Research* 28(2):229–46.

Bourdieu, Pierre. 2000. *Pascalian meditations*. Stanford: Stanford University Press.

Burawoy, Michael. 2012. "The Roots of Domination." *Sociology* 46(2):187–206.

Chiapello, Eve. 2003. "Reconciling the Two Principal Meanings of the Notion of Ideology." *European Journal of Social Theory* 6(2):155–71.

Cramer, Katherine J. 2016. *The Politics of Resentment*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.

Day, Martin. 2021. Barriers to equality: Your misestimates of other people's beliefs about inequality. In *Presentation at the International Society for Justice Research, 18th Biennual Conference*, Lisbon, Portugal (Virtual).

Duffy, Mignon. 2007. "Doing the Dirty Work." *Gender & Society* 21(3):313–36.

Durkheim, Émile. 1893, 2013. *The Division of Labour in Society*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.

Feldman, Glenn (ed.) 2004. *Before Brown*. Tuscaloosa: University of Alabama Press.

Foucault, Michel. 1977. *Discipline and Punish*. New York: Pantheon.

François, Abel, Raul Magni-Berton, and Simon Varaine. 2021. "Revolutionary Attitudes in Democratic Regimes." *Political Studies* 69(2):214–36.

Ganzeboom, Harry B.G., Paul M. de Graaf, and Donald J. Treiman. 1992. "A standard international socio-economic index of occupational status." *Social Science Research* 21(1):1–56.

Gramsci, Antonio. 1932. "Fourth Notebook". In *Prison Notebooks Vol. 2*, edited by Buttigieg, J. (2011), pp. 135–264. New York: Columbia University Press.

Hedström, Peter, and Petri Ylikoski. 2010. "Causal Mechanisms in the Social Sciences." *Annual Review of Sociology* 36(1):49–67.

Hegtvedt, Karen A., and Cathryn Johnson. 2000. "Justice beyond the Individual." *Social Psychology Quarterly* 63(4):298–311.

Hochschild, Arlie R. 2016. *Strangers in their own land*. New York: The New Press.

Jasso, Guillermina. 1978. "On the Justice of Earnings: A New Specification of the Justice Evaluation Function." *American Journal of Sociology* 83(6):1398–419.

Jost, John T., Vivienne Badaan, Shahrzad Goudarzi, Mark Hoffarth, and Mao Mogami. 2019. "The Future of System Justification Theory." *The British Journal of Social Psychology* 58(2):382–92.

Kuran, Timur. 1987. "Preference Falsification, Policy Continuity and Collective Conservatism." *The Economic Journal* 97(387):642–65.

Kuran, Timur. 1997. *Private truths, public lies: The social consequences of preference falsification*. Cambridge, Mass: Harvard University Press.

Lerner, Melvin J. 1980. *The Belief in a Just World*. New York: Plenum Press.

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Lukes, Steven. 2005. *Power: a radical view*. London: Palgrave.
Lukács, Georg. 1923 1972. *History and Class Consciousness*. Cambridge MA: MIT Press.
Lewis, David. 1969 2013. *Convention: A Philosophical Study*. Hoboken: Wiley.
Marx, Karl, and Friedrich Engels. 18461998. *The German ideology*. Amherst: Prometheus Books.
Marx, Karl. 1844. "A Contribution to the Critique of Hegel's Philosophy of Right: Introduction". In *The Marx-Engels reader*, edited by Tucker, R. (1978), pp. 53–65. New York: Norton.
Marx, Karl. 1859. "Preface to the Contribution to the Critique of Political Economy". In *The Marx-Engels reader*, edited by Tucker, R. (1978), pp. 3–6. New York: Norton.
Marx, Karl. 1867 1909. "Capital: A Critique of Political Economy". In *Vol. I: The Process of Capitalist Production*. Chicago: Kerr & Co.
McAdam, Doug, Sidney Tarrow, and Charles Tilly. 2001. *Dynamics of contention*. New York: Cambridge University Press.
Olson, Mancur. 1965 1971. *The Logic of Collective Action*. Cambridge, Mass: Harvard University Press.
Parsons, Talcott. 1951 1991. *The social system*. London: Routledge & Kegan Paul.
Prentice, Deborah A., and Dale T. Miller. 1996. "Pluralistic Ignorance and the Perpetuation of Social Norms by Unwitting Actors." *Advances in Experimental Social Psychology* 28:161–209.
Postone, Moishe. 1993. *Time, labor, and social domination*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
Puga, Ismael. 2011. "Lo Justo y lo Posible". In *Desigualdad, legitimación y conflicto*, edited by Castillo, M., Bastias, M., Durand, A., Zapata, F. (2011), pp. 139–60. Santiago: UAH.
Puga, Ismael. 2013. The Legitimation of Social Inequalities in Chile. Ph.D. diss., *Institute for Social Sciences*, Humboldt University Berlin.
Puga, Ismael. 2021. "Ideological Inversion and the (De)legitimation of Neoliberalism in Chile". In *The Oxford Handbook of the Sociology of Latin America*, edited by Rivera, L., Bada, X. (2021), pp. 213–30. London: Oxford University Press.
Puga, Ismael, and Cristóbal Moya. 2020. "El mecanismo de inversión ideológica." *Revista Internacional de Sociología* 78(2):e157.
Ridgeway, Cecilia L., and Shelley J. Correll. 2006. "Consensus and the Creation of Status Beliefs." *Social Forces* 85(1):431–53.
Rodríguez, Juan. 2020. "From 'Laboratory' to 'Paradise'". In *Resisting Neoliberal Capitalism in Chile*, edited by Rodríguez, J. (2020), pp. 109–17. Cham: Palgrave McMillan.
Schmid, Michael. 2011. "The logic of mechanismic explanations in the social sciences". In *Analytical Sociology and Social Mechanisms*, edited by Demeulenaere, Pierre (2011), pp. 136–53. New York: Cambridge University Press.
Schoon, E. W. 2022. "Operationalizing Legitimacy". *American Sociological Review (Online First)*.
Siavelis, Peter. 2016. "Crisis of Representation in Chile?" *Journal of Politics in Latin America* 8(3):61–93.
Weber, Max. 1920. "Basic Sociological Terms". In *Economy and Society*, edited by Roth, Guenther, Wittich, Claus (1998), pp. 3–62. Berkeley CA: University of California Press.
Weber, Max. 1922. "The Types of Legitimate Domination". In *Economy and Society*, edited by Roth, Guenther, Wittich, Claus (1998), pp. 212–301. Berkeley CA: University of California Press.
Zomeren, Martijn van, Tom Postmes, and Russell Spears. 2008. "Toward an Integrative Social Identity Model of Collective Action." *Psychological Bulletin* 134(4):504–35.

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

APPENDIX A: ADDITIONAL TABLES

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Table A1. Factors and Categories in Vignettes

Factor	Categories (communication in Spanish)	
Occupation	• Housework *(Labores del hogar)*.	• Medical center receptionist *(Recepcionista en un consultorio)*.
	• Corporate Lawyer *(Abogado en una gran empresa)*.	• Food-plant unskilled worker *(Operario/a en una planta procesadora de alimentos)*.
	• Supermarket cash register supervisor *(Supervisor/a de cajas en supermercado)*.	• Owner of a mid-size firm *(Dueño/a de una empresa mediana de producción de plásticos)*.
	• Highschool Teacher *(Profesor/a de secundaria)*.	• Policeman *(Cabo de Carabineros)*.
Gender	• Male (implied in name* and grammar).	• Female (implied in name* and grammar).
School choice (for Alter's Children)	• Public School *(matriculó a sus hijos en una escuela pública)*.	• Private School *(matriculó a sus hijos en un colegio particular pagado)*.
	• Charter School *(matriculó a sus hijos en una escuela subvencionada)*.	• No children *(no tiene hijos)*.
Vote	• Rightwing *(votó por Sebastián Piñera, candidato por Chile Vamos)*.	• Leftwing *(votó por Beatriz Sánchez, candidata por el Frente Amplio)*.
	• Center–Left *(votó por Alejandro Guillier, candidato por la Nueva Mayoría)*.	• Did not vote *(no votó)*.
Relative finances	• Faring pretty good *(en términos económicos le va bastante bien)*.	• Faring not that good *(en términos económicos no le va tan bien)*.
Neighborhood status	• Impoverished *(en un barrio empobrecido)*.	• Accommodated *(en un barrio acomodado)*.
City	• Santiago.	• Antofagasta
	• Valparaiso.	• Temuco
Age group	• 27/29 (random number within range).	• 44/46 (random number within range)
	• 35/37 (random number within range).	• 52/54 (random number within range)
Alter's father education	• University degree *(su padre completó estudios universitarios)*.	• No degree *(su padre no terminó la educación media)*.

*Each vignette within each deck was randomly assigned with a different name from a list of 8. The selection of these followed two criteria: names with clearly distinct male and female versions; names not associated with any specific social background in Chile. The list includes (for male/female): Alejandro/Alejandra; Andrés/Andrea; Antonio/Antonia; Camilo/Camila; Carlos/Carla; Claudio/Claudia; Francisco/Francisca; Pablo/Paula.

Table A2. Descriptive Statistics

Variable	Ego Level (weighted)								Alter Level (not weighted)							
	n	Mean/ Freq	SD	Range		Percentiles			n	Mean/ Freq	SD	Range		Percentiles		
						10%	50%	90%						10%	50%	90%
Sex																
Female	1,290	0.52	0.50	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.50	0.50	0	1	—	—	—
Male	1,290	0.48	0.50	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.50	0.50	0	1	—	—	—
Age	1,290	37.24	12.20	18	60	21	36	55	10,320	40.55	9.37	28	53	28	45	53
Net Labor Income (CLP) Class/Occupation	747	883,60	1,201,98	20	8,000	200	500	2,500	0	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Firm Owner	1,290	0.01	0.09	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.12	0.33	0	1	—	—	—
Reproductive Labor	1,290	0.12	0.33	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.13	0.33	0	1	—	—	—
ISEI	938	43.82	22.62	11.6	88.3	16.50	36.35	80.78	9,030	54.99	21.36	22.8	86.7	39.02	51.50	86.72
Father has Univ, Degree City	1,290	0.23	0.42	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.50	0.50	0	1	—	—	—
Antofagasta	1,290	0.05	0.22	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.25	0.43	0	1	—	—	—
Temuco	1,290	0.04	0.19	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.25	0.44	0	1	—	—	—
Santiago	1,290	0.91	0.29	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.25	0.43	0	1	—	—	—
Valparaiso	1,290	0.00	0.00	0	0	—	—	—	10,320	0.24	0.43	0	1	—	—	—
School Choice																
No Children	1,290	0.34	0.47	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.25	0.43	0	1	—	—	—

(*Continued*)

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Table A2. Continued

Variable	Ego Level (weighted)								Alter Level (not weighted)							
	n	Mean/ Freq	SD	Range		Percentiles			n	Mean/ Freq	SD	Range		Percentiles		
						10%	50%	90%						10%	50%	90%
Public	1,290	0.21	0.41	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.25	0.43	0	1	—	—	—
Charter	1,290	0.23	0.42	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.25	0.43	0	1	—	—	—
Private	1,290	0.13	0.34	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.25	0.43	0	1	—	—	—
Vote																
Did not vote	1,290	0.38	0.49	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.25	0.43	0	1	—	—	—
Rightwing (CV)	1,290	0.25	0.43	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.25	0.43	0	1	—	—	—
Center–left (NM)	1,290	0.09	0.29	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.25	0.43	0	1	—	—	—
Left (FA)	1,290	0.19	0.39	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.25	0.43	0	1	—	—	—
Others	1,290	0.09	0.28	0	1	—	—	—	10,320	0.00	0.00	0	1	—	—	—
Ideas																
On Politics	1,286	7.72	3.99	1	11	1	10	11	10,266	6.01	4.40	1	11	1	6	11
On Economics	1,284	9.21	2.98	1	11	4	11	11	10,238	8.05	3.89	1	11	1	11	11
Perception of Anomie	1,278	0.00	1.41	—5.47	2.82	−2.18	0.10	1.68	0	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Participation into CA	1,290	0.36	0.48	0	1	—	—	—	0	—	—	—	—	—	—	—

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Table A3. Linear Models on Ego and Alter's Ideas

	Economics Dimension					Politics Dimension				
	Model 1 Ego's Ideas			Model 2 Alter's Ideas		Model 3 Ego's Ideas		Model 4 Alter's Ideas		
	Coef.		SE	Coef.	SE	Coef.	SE	Coef.		SE
Social Positions										
Sex: Women (ref: Men)	0.372		0.576	0.501 *	0.246	0.234	0.785	1.022	***	0.277
Age (years)	0.024		0.016	−0.010 **	0.003	−0.036	0.881	−0.015	***	0.004
Father's has University Degree	−0.130		0.714	−0.111	0.157	1.197	0.881	−0.226		0.177
Occupation										
Firm Owner	−0.094		1.136	−1.391 ***	0.096	1.644	0.874	0.149		0.109
Reproductive Labor	0.133		0.485	0.081	0.187	−2.216	2.089	0.957	***	0.211
ISEI	0.004		0.011	0.005	0.004	0.029	0.017	0.011	*	0.004
City (ref: Santiago)										
Antofagasta	0.373		0.296	0.157	0.092	−0.657	0.502	−0.430	***	0.104
Temuco	0.787	**	0.295	−0.120	0.090	−0.559	0.449	−0.435	***	0.102
Valparaiso				0.269 **	0.091			−0.146		0.103
Practices										
School Choice (ref: no children)										
Public	−0.551		0.935	0.869 ***	0.263	1.168	1.066	0.617	*	0.297
Charter	0.140		0.849	−0.038	0.274	0.921	1.212	−0.012		0.308
Private	−0.905		1.866	−0.516	0.265	1.525	1.995	−1.173	***	0.299
Vote (ref: did not vote)										
Rightwing	−0.215		0.856	−0.636 *	0.249	0.657	0.919	−0.774	**	0.281
Center Left	1.116	*	0.495	0.666 **	0.255	1.761	1.083	1.936	***	0.287

(*Continued*)

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Table A3. Continued

	Economics Dimension						Politics Dimension					
	Model 1 Ego's Ideas			Model 2 Alter's Ideas			Model 3 Ego's Ideas			Model 4 Alter's Ideas		
	Coef.		SE	Coef.		SE	Coef.		SE	Coef.		SE
Leftwing	2.103	***	0.443	0.950	***	0.260	2.552	***	0.771	1.686	***	0.294
Others	0.173		0.473				−0.827		0.722			
Interactions between positions												
Women # Father's Education (UD)	−1.128		0.775	−0.195		0.146	−2.105		0.950	−0.103		0.164
Women # Reproductive Labor	−0.402		0.773	−0.909	***	0.271	2.744		2.213	−1.024	***	0.305
Women # ISEI	0.009		0.012	−0.006		0.003	−0.005		0.016	−0.009	*	0.004
Father's Education (UD) # ISEI	−0.006		0.014	0.000		0.002	0.017		0.018	0.003		0.003
Interactions between practices												
Public School # Vote												
Rightwing	1.419		1.078	−0.008		0.262	−0.172		1.173	0.503		0.295
Center Left	0.566		0.698	−0.595	*	0.267	−0.757		1.288	−0.612	*	0.301
Leftwing	0.236		0.637	−0.717	**	0.271	−0.902		0.959	0.215		0.305
Charter School # Vote												
Rightwing	0.440		1.184	0.481		0.269	−2.259		1.324	−0.101		0.303
Center Left	−0.408		0.677	0.227		0.265	−0.717		1.241	−0.307		0.299
Leftwing	0.077		0.657	0.066		0.267	−0.395		1.014	0.073		0.301
Private School # Vote												
Rightwing	1.992		1.196	0.379		0.259	−2.118		1.607	0.475		0.292

(Continued)

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Table A3. Continued

	Economics Dimension						Politics Dimension					
	Model 1 Ego's Ideas			Model 2 Alter's Ideas			Model 3 Ego's Ideas			Model 4 Alter's Ideas		
	Coef.		SE	Coef.		SE	Coef.		SE	Coef.		SE
Center Left	1.960	*	0.933	0.188		0.262	1.441		1.614	−0.049		0.295
Leftwing	2.435		2.237	0.516		0.266	−1.048		1.848	0.637	*	0.300
Interactions between positions and practices												
Women # School Choice												
Public	−0.402		0.734	0.166		0.187	−0.636		0.891	−0.599	**	0.211
Charter	−0.335		0.702	0.272		0.192	−0.323		0.921	−0.499	*	0.216
Private	0.493		1.567	−0.075		0.196	−1.685		1.597	−0.155		0.221
ISEI # School Choice												
Public	0.006		0.013	0.000		0.003	0.007		0.019	0.000		0.004
Charter	0.003		0.012	−0.002		0.003	−0.012		0.017	0.007		0.004
Private	−0.016		0.019	0.001		0.003	−0.016		0.024	0.009	*	0.004
ISEI # Vote												
Rightwing	−0.026		0.013	−0.008	*	0.004	−0.021		0.019	−0.011	**	0.004
Center Left	0.001		0.011	−0.008	*	0.004	−0.017		0.018	−0.012	**	0.004
Leftwing	−0.023		0.012	−0.001		0.004	−0.023		0.016	−0.010	*	0.004
Constant	8.052	***	0.660	8.003	***	0.302	7.665	***	0.875	5.983	***	0.339
Sigma U				1.658		0.048				1.681		0.053
Sigma E				3.159		0.024				3.577		0.027
Rho				0.216		0.010				0.181		0.010
R2	0.150						0.123					
N	1,284			10,238			1,286			10,266		

*$P <= 0.05$. **$P <= 0.01$. ***$P <= 0.001$.

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Table A4. Linear Models on Ego's Expected Ideas

	EEI (Economics) Coef. (SE)		EEI (Politics) Coef. (SE)	
SAI (Economics)	0.856	***		
	(0.031)			
SAI (Politics)			0.905	***
			(0.027)	
Constant	2.401	***	2.172	***
	(0.249)		(0.166)	
Adj. R2	0.370		0.471	
N	1,290		1,290	

*$P <= 0.05$. **$P <= 0.01$. ***$P <= 0.001$.

Table A5. Paired *t*-Tests For the Difference Between Socially Attributed Ideas and Ego's Expected Ideas

	Politics Dimension			Economics Dimension		
Variable/Subcategory	Mean Dif. (SAI—EEI)		*t*	Mean Dif. (SAI—EEI)		t
Total	−1.59	***	−55.74	−1.26	***	−48.98
Sex						
Men	−2.16	***	−48.26	−1.25	***	−38.22
Women	−1.05	***	−40.53	−1.27	***	−33.56
Occupation						
Reproductive Labor	−1.18	***	−24.19	−1.73	***	−19.71
ISEI: Quartile 1	−1.27	***	−23.46	−1.02	***	−22.63
ISEI: Quartile 2	−1.66	***	−34.48	−1.21	***	−25.37
ISEI: Quartile 3	−1.82	***	−29.5	−1.32	***	−31.67
ISEI: Quartile 4	−1.85	***	−18.83	−1.22	***	−16.78
Age						
18/29 years old	−1.72	***	−35.64	−0.95	***	−28.50
30/39 years old	−1.57	***	−26.68	−1.12	***	−22.60
40/49 years old	−1.41	***	−21.85	−1.40	***	−22.03
50/60 years old	−1.57	***	−26.39	−1.80	***	−33.78

(*Continued*)

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Table A5. Continued

Variable/Subcategory	Politics Dimension			Economics Dimension		
	Mean Dif. (SAI—EEI)		*t*	Mean Dif. (SAI—EEI)		t
City						
Santiago	−1.61	***	−37.63	−1.22	***	−31.88
Antofagasta	−1.32	***	−25.23	−1.34	***	−28.80
Temuco	−1.40	***	−25.47	−2.15	***	−48.58
School Choice						
Public	−1.48	***	−34.75	−0.79	***	−16.25
Charter	−1.34	***	−29.43	−1.64	***	−42.87
Private	−1.51	***	−8.38	−1.41	***	−8.11
Vote						
Rightwing	−1.76	***	−22.46	−1.30	***	−22.10
Center Left	−1.28	***	−18.78	−2.26	***	−32.62
Leftwing	−1.76	***	−25.65	−1.52	***	−31.90
Others	−0.98	***	−11.13	−1.22	***	−14.52

$^{*}P <= 0.05$. $^{**}P <= 0.01$. $^{***}P <= 0.001$.

Table A6. MLE Null Linear Models on Alter's Expected Ideas

	Model 1 IEA (Economics) Coef. (SE)	Model 2 IEA (Politics) Coef. (SE)
Constant	9.657	8.269
	(0.013)	(0.020)
Sigma U	0.000	0.000
	(0.018)	(0.026)
Sigma E	1.371	2.006
	(0.010)	(0.014)
Rho	0.000	0.000
N	10,320	10,320

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026

Table A7. Logistic Models on the Participation into Collective Actions Oriented Toward Social Change

	Model 1			Model 2			Model 3		
	OR		Exp SE	OR		Exp SE	OR		Exp SE
Ego's Ideological Bias									
On Economics				0.986		1.163	0.830		1.183
On Politics				1.702	***	1.136	1.582	***	1.143
Ego's Ideas									
On Economics							1.087	**	1.028
On Politics							1.068	***	1.019
Social Positions									
Sex: Women (ref: Men)	1.087		1.150	1.076		1.152	1.089		1.154
Age (years)	0.962	***	1.007	0.964	***	1.007	0.963	***	1.007
Father's Education: University Degree	0.510	***	1.205	0.459	***	1.206	0.471	***	1.210
Occupation									
Reproductive Labor	0.380	***	1.327	0.394	**	1.329	0.365	***	1.336
ISEI	1.005		1.003	1.006		1.003	1.006		1.004
Labor Income	1.000	**	1.000	1.000	**	1.000	1.000	*	1.000
No labor income (ref: has labor income)	2.085	***	1.192	2.029	***	1.195	2.104	***	1.199
City (ref: Santiago)									
Antofagasta	1.431		1.321	1.431		1.323	1.534		1.330
Temuco	1.985	*	1.379	2.219	*	1.387	2.190	*	1.395
Practices									
School Choice (ref: no children)									
Public	1.306		1.206	1.263		1.211	1.228		1.212
Charter	1.132		1.194	1.120		1.196	1.150		1.199
Private	0.483	*	1.358	0.485	*	1.355	0.562		1.359
Vote (ref: did not vote)									
Rightwing	0.524	***	1.209	0.490	***	1.212	0.532	**	1.217
Center Left	1.237		1.271	1.185		1.271	1.011		1.278
Leftwing	4.000	***	1.197	3.922	***	1.199	3.161	***	1.208
Others	1.148		1.269	1.104		1.271	1.118		1.276
Constant	1.218		1.297	1.622		1.335	0.414	*	1.526

*$P <= 0.05$. **$P <= 0.01$. ***$P <= 0.001$.

Downloaded from academic.oup.com/sf/article/101/3/1519/6562932 by Instituto de Estudios Internacionales user on 13 October 2026